focus for any national uprising, would therefore, be very limited unless a political opposition at the national level is created to which the militant group gets linked. Major Zia's was another group, which emerged after the third coup, but it was mainly active in the Sunderbans area. This group was primarily a body of about seventy deserters who had probably committed themselves too obviously in support of Khaled Mosharraf's abortive coup and deserted the army to avoid reprisals. During the brief period of their hey-day, their activities could mainly be described as those of freebooters and they did not show any particular political ideology or commitment. They were involved in stray attacks on isolated forest establishment and river craft in the Sundarbans region. In a concerted operation by Bangladesh army—Operation Python—about fifty-odd have either been captured or have surrendered. It is possible that the residue of this group may try to make their way to the stronghold of an established group like Kader Bahini as otherwise they would be completely destroyed and the leaders, at least, could not hope for mercy at the hands of present administration. As an effective fighting force, the group has, however, been eradicated by the operations that were mounted and the police forces are now being used for mopping up the stragglers. Another militant group in active conflict with the administration is the Shanti Bahini, the militant wing of the Chakma movement for autonomy, the Jana Sanghati Samiti. This group was also opposed to the Sheikh Mujib government, demanding for autonomy and protection of their customary rights. The level of their activities has not in any way increased since the coup of 15 August, though there are reports from time to time of intensified recruitment and training and of concentration of insurgents. The movement, while espousing the cause of secession, would probably fizzle out if a fair degree of autonomy is provided and certain safeguards against